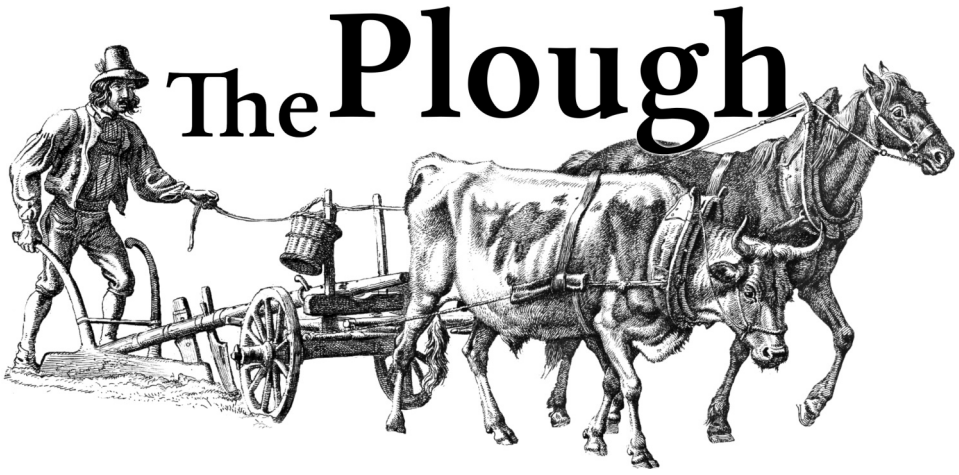


The Plough

NEMO MITTENS MANUM SUAM AD ARATRUM, ET RESPICIENS RETRO, APTUS EST REGNO DEI
NO MAN PUTTING HIS HAND TO THE PLOUGH, AND LOOKING BACK, IS FIT FOR THE KINGDOM OF GOD

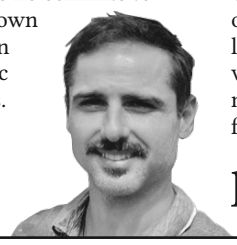
Featuring

Issue September 2026

The Old Urbanism: Part II

Josue Hernandez

Continuing from last month's issue, our author gives his inspiring account of the fruits of his labour as he commits to building a town on European and Catholic foundations.

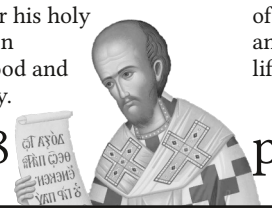


pg. 5

Sermon on Women

St John Chrysostom

Known as the Golden-Tongued, this Church Father is regarded as one of the best orators of both west and east. No less than his oration was his moral rectitude: let us hear his holy wisdom on motherhood and femininity.

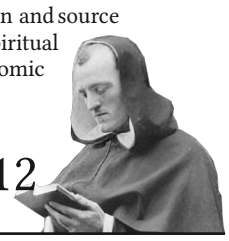


pg. 8

The Land and Unemployment

Fr Vincent McNabb

Is unemployment even possible on a farm? The much beloved Hiberno-English Dominican preaches the land as the foundation and source of both spiritual and economic life.



pg. 12

Integralism is not Interpretive

Christian by Nature & Catholic in Origin

Arno Arcand, Sardá y Salvany

Translator's Preface

Sardá y Salvany requires little introduction to those already acquainted with his celebrated work *El Liberalismo es Pecado* (*Liberalism is a Sin*) which had by this time earned wide circulation across Europe and the Americas, and which had received the formal approbation of the Sacred Congregation of the Index in Rome. This work may be read as a companion to that work, sharper in tone, more urgent in feeling, and more explicitly concerned with the positive alternative to Liberalism which he names *Integralism*: *the uncompromising acknowledgment of the full and integral rights of God over every domain of human society.*

Integralism Conference

Opening

"Integralists? Yes, my lords, and proudly so." Wishing to address you today in our beloved academy, after so long a time away, certainly not for lack of will, I thought it fitting to choose as the theme of this informal lecture the very nickname or label with which our enemies have sought, for some time now, to defame us. With it, I would wish you to feel, as I assure you I feel, by the grace of God, a saintly pride and a Christian dignity: proud of my faith, of my Baptism, of my Catholic upbringing, of my Catholic priesthood, and of all that constitutes, thanks to Heaven, my manner of being in the supernatural and Christian order.

Yes, my friends: I am an integralist, and I desire that all members of this society be integralists. I consider any man to be an integralist of whom I have a favorable opinion regarding his customs and beliefs, and I would wish the whole world to be integralist, the only way for all to be recognized children and obedient subjects of God our Lord.

Let us then claim loudly and proudly this label, which our enemies mean as a slur, but which is nothing other than most glorious. Let us raise it high, very high, as an immortal banner that symbolizes all our aspirations, recalls all our duties, wondrously dignifies our condition in modern social life, and separates us with a distinctive mark from all that, in greater or lesser degree, belongs to the reigning liberalism.

Let us speak, then, of integralism, and with a manly face and steadfast heart, let us accept it with all its consequences.

The Enemy's Strategy: Nicknames as Weapons

It has been a constant tactic of the enemies of Catholicism to always seek disguises and nicknames with which to attack its children, so as to make it appear they were attacking them not for being Catholics, but for something quite separate from that essential character. Almost every heresy has invented a nickname with which to reproach Catholics, pretending that they were not fighting them as such, but on account of some other concept expressed by that label.

Yet it has always turned out that the chosen label has been, as it were, an unconscious and involuntary revelation of something glorious about those labelled, and simply recording it in history is enough, generally, to resolve the matter with full justice.

For instance, looking only at recent centuries, the *Anglicans* thought they had triumphed by calling *"Papists"* those who refused to accept the scandalous schism of Henry VIII. Were those brave Englishmen, who so generously gave their lives to maintain inviolable fidelity to the Holy See, ashamed of that insult? Scarcely.

Subsequently, the *Jansenists*, the *Gallicans*, and the *regalists*, all of whom can be grouped together as more or less open forerunners of modern liberalism, invented in France the nickname *"Ultramontanes"* to designate the faithful from beyond the Pyrenees and the Apennines, that is, the Spaniards and Italians who were most opposed to the innovating tendencies of that cunning sect.

And today, Catholics in France are not persecuted for being Catholics — for the devil, who is wicked but not foolish, is too clever to fall into such an obvious blunder. They are persecuted, rather, for being *"clericals"* — for well known is the phrase or battle cry: *"Clericalism is the enemy!"*

The same occurs in Spain today. Blessed be God! To attack the Catholic host that most desires to distinguish itself in zeal and ardor for the defense of Catholicism, to fight valiantly for Catholic enterprises and publications that wish to be inspired only by the most ardent Catholicism; to combat fiercely and relentlessly Catholic men who refuse to distinguish themselves under any other banner than that of pure and clean Catholicism — oh! That would be childish naivety or unaccustomed frankness, faults into which our clever opponents never fall.

No, no one, nothing is attacked or denigrated for being Catholic — not even out of consideration, as they say, for the so-called inviolable rights of human conscience. What is ferociously denigrated and ceaselessly combated without rest is being *integralists.*

Integralism as Honor

Already it is clear that Catholicism has persuaded many anti-Catholics that it is serious and respectable, or at least tolerable. What equally convinces everyone, both frank anti-Catholics and half-hearted Catholics alike, is that the wicked and perverse ones are the integralists. One might say that the time has come in Spain to raise, as a banner of social defense, a slogan analogous to the one Gambetta raised in France: *"Integralism, yes, Integralism, that is the enemy."*

Very well, my lords; and we can count ourselves greatly honored that in this way we are singled out for public contempt and scorn. But this very fact gives us the right to take up that glorious insult, analyze it in cold blood, and conclude — not to convince ourselves, for by the mercy of God we are already convinced — but to convince our adversaries that this is truly our first badge of honor and our title of glory.

God: The First Integralist

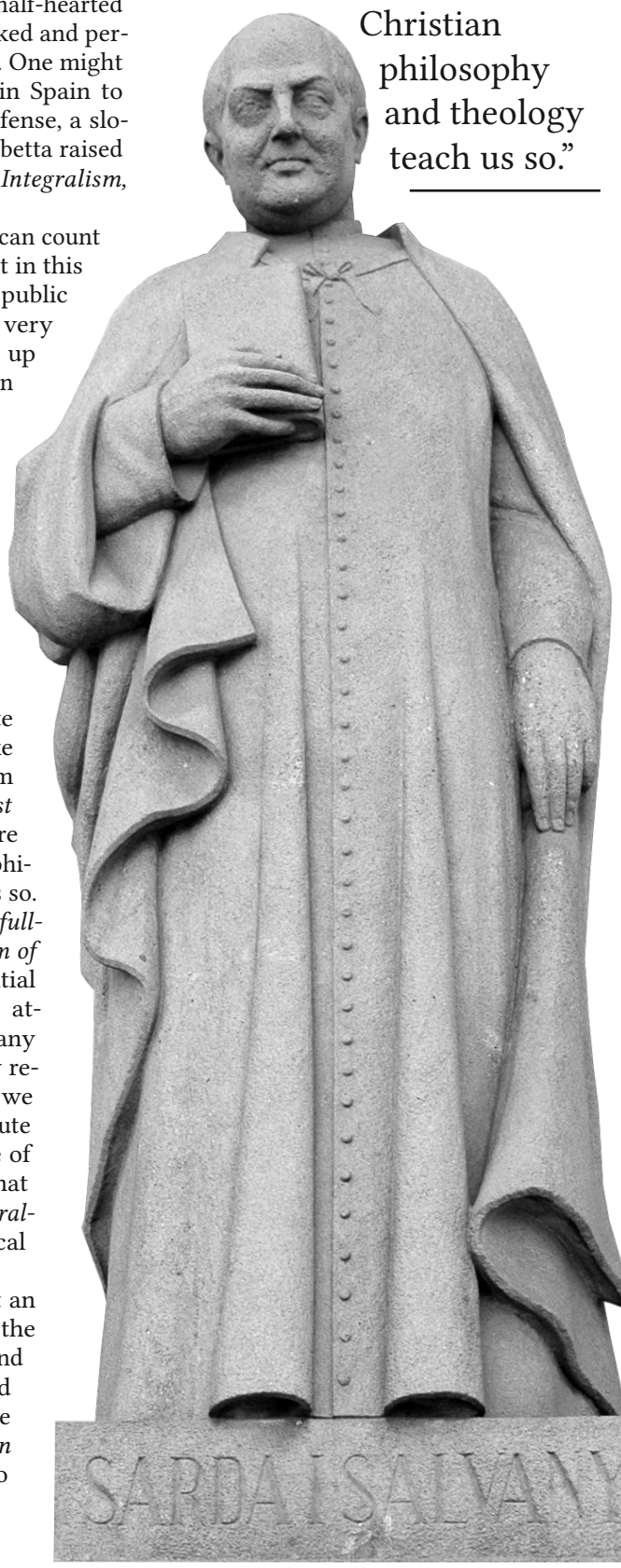
To some of our unfortunate adversaries, it may seem like blasphemy when we tell them that *the first integralist is Christ our Lord.* And yet that is where we begin, and both Christian philosophy and theology teach us so.

In God is found the *integral fullness of being* and the *whole sum of integral perfection.* The essential integrity of His sovereign attributes is not diminished by any deficiency, nor limited by any restriction whatsoever. Just as we say that God is pure and absolute Being without any admixture of non-being, so we can affirm that *the Divine Essence is pure integralism* in its highest philosophical and transcendental meaning.

In God there is nothing but an infinite and eternal love of the good, paired with an infinite and eternal hatred of evil, a hatred and love that are unified in one single attribute: *His sovereign and eternal justice.* And so

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"To some of our unfortunate adversaries, it may seem like blasphemy when we tell them that *the first integralist is Christ our Lord.* And yet that is where we begin, and both Christian philosophy and theology teach us so."



Integralism is not Interpretive Cont.

Continued from Page 1

greatly does God love the good and hate the evil that He cannot in any way hold that hatred and that love less intensely or in an attenuated form, nay, His very divine essence compels Him, so to speak, to love the loveable infinitely, and to hate the abominable infinitely. To the point that He would cease to be God if that integralism of love for the good and that integralism of hatred for the evil ceased to exist in Him.

In that sense, the word *integralism* resounds as an expression of the absolutely perfect. We can truly say that when the divine Word invites us, with divine calling, to imitate, insofar as our frail nature allows, the very perfection of the Heavenly Father, with that: *"Be perfect as your Heavenly Father is perfect"* (*Estote ergo vos perfecti, sicut et Pater vester caelestis perfectus est*). He invites us to be good and perfect *integralists.*

To support this interpretation with an authoritative Church father, I would cite the brother of our glorious Apostle of Spain, who exhorts us in his canonical epistle: *"ut sitis perfecti et integri in nullo deficientes,"—"that you be perfect and whole, lacking in nothing."*

And we could also cite that other text of Saint Paul to Titus, in which he tells him to show himself in all things as an example of good works, in doctrine, *integrity*, and dignity: *"teipsum praebe exemplum bonorum operum, in doctrina, in integritate, in gravitate."*

The ideas of integrity and holiness are not merely analogous, they are perfectly *identical.* The Academy's dictionary defines holiness as *integrity of life.* And so, as we have said, the integralist *par excellence* is Our Lord; after Him, the saints are the great integralists of the human race, and at their head, that most glorious Queen, the Mother of God. This immaculate integrity most closely and most brilliantly reflects that of the Blessed Trinity and of the humanity of her most Holy Son.

Admirable integrity! Incomparable integrity! Of which one might say with the poet: *"a glimpse of what man could have been, a glimpse of what he was before sin."* For do not the theologians call our primitive, not yet stained by original guilt, an *integral nature* (*status naturae integrae*)?

Let us place this issue, my good sirs, on the firm field of its right natural sense, wherein a certain class of enemies are most prone to confusion. That abominable Integralism of which we are accused of at every hour, as if it were a crime or a sectarian idea deserving of all anathemas; that Integralism is only decried as a horror when it is applied to the distinct order of ideas which constitutes the public law of Christianity. In any other sphere, integralism seems to our enemies something very dignified, honorable, and even indispensable.

Integralism in Everyday Life

Let us look at some examples, for we have them as close as one can get, right before our very eyes, vivid and palpable.

As a merchant: my friend, and you believe that all business must be conducted with the most exquisite honesty and good faith. You allow yourself no compromises of conscience in any transaction, nor do you tolerate them in your managers and subordinates. You carry this strictness to the point of scruple, and in your ledgers, as in your correspondence, as in your verbal dealings, the very idea of finding even a single blot that might cloud your clean reputation as an upright gentleman revolts you. Tell me now, do you know what you are, with those scrupulous ideas of mercantile conscience? Well then, know it, even if it surprises you: *you are an integralist.* What you profess and practice is nothing other than *commercial integralism.*

As a magistrate: say, for example, as mayor of your city or village; you carry out the elevated ministry of a judge, or simply the more modest role of a municipal magistrate, and you hold these offices in such high esteem in the Christian republic, truly very high, that you strive and labor tirelessly day and night for the most exact fulfillment of them, and not only will you not bend the rules or accept bribes (as the old Castilian phrase goes) but looking upon the interests of your administered as sacred things, you see in each one of them and in their goods and honor a deposit for which you will be called to give the gravest account before God. Therefore, if no lawful defraudation of any of it occurs through your fault, nor any negligence or sluggishness on your part in attending to their defense, then in you is realized the most beautiful type of the good public official, father of his subordinates, and living image upon earth of the justice and providence of God. They will call you, then, with full mouth, a good mayor, an upright magistrate. Do you know, however, what you really are? Nothing more nor less than *an upright integralist.* What you profess and practice is most nobly called *administrative and judicial integralism.*

As a soldier: Few careers are as noble and as honorable as the *military.* The citizen who, in order to defend his homeland and the laws, makes himself a slave of the profession of discipline — subject to the most austere duties — swears to fulfill them, knowing that to fail in them means forfeiting not only his personal liberty, but from that first moment he renounced becoming a servant of the Ordinance, as well as the peace of his whole existence, the dearest affections of family, his own health, life itself. Thus one sees him stand fearlessly before the greatest dangers to harden himself in the most grueling fatigues, to impose upon himself, as something ordinary and customary, the practice of the greatest sacrifices. He lives by his banner and dies for it. This man, whom all the world will call a good soldier, and whom history will salute with the title of hero, what, in the end, has he been? Simply an integralist, a fanatical sectarian of what we might call *the integralism of conscience and military honor.*

"Admirable integrity! Incomparable integrity! Of which one might say with the poet: *'a glimpse of what man could have been, a glimpse of what he was before sin.'"*

As a husband and father: Sacred are the laws of conjugal and domestic society. God and the Church demand of it a moral unity far more strict, much more strict, than what the world usually authorizes, and which, unfortunately, is in this regard as morally suspect as it is in everything else. Conforming yourselves to these ideas, you guard and demand that the honor and decorum of your home be kept with the inviolable reverence of a sanctuary. You are vigilant not only for what we might call the material order of your house and family, but also for your own moral prestige — you impose upon yourselves and upon your loved ones every kind of reserve and self-denial. The good name of your wife, the pure aureole of your daughters' innocence, the unblemished reputation of your sons, these are treasures you would not compromise for anything this world could offer. You would expose yourselves to anything, resign yourselves to anything, in order to prevent any stain upon the honor of your family name, not merely a grave accusation, but not even a murmur of gossip nor the most veiled reticence. Now then, do you know what you are with all that? You are nothing less than a *perfect integralist*, an intransigent guardian of the integralism of your household.

The One Integralism They Hate

Let us move on, my lords, from the

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Citizenship

Meditations for Layfolk

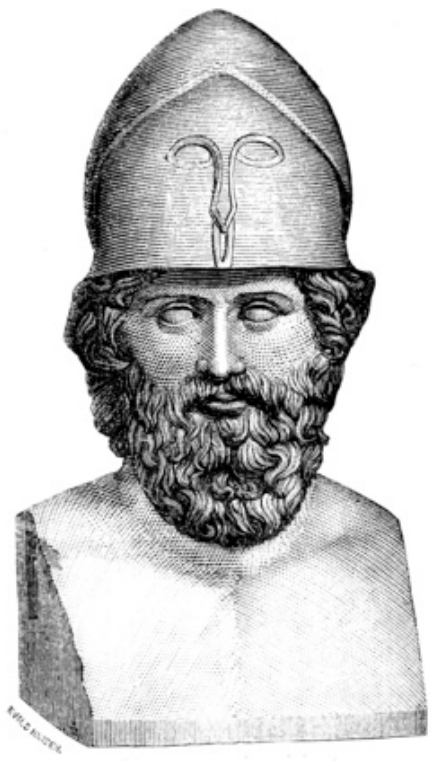
Fr Bede Jarrett

From his work Meditations for Layfolk, *published in 1915.*

Among the Greeks it was considered a noble ambition to serve the State. The writings of Aristotle and his fellows, the dialogues of Plato, are full of the same idea. To vote and speak, to take part in the assembly, to become an influence in directing the national policy, was looked upon as the highest possible service that man could render to God. For them our ideal of Church and State, separate and free, would have made no appeal, not because they made the Church into the State, but the State into the Church. For them there was really no distinction between the two; not because God had become man, and the Divine was to take charge of the human, but because man had become God, and the human was the Divine. In consequence, every action done for the benefit of the State was itself an act of piety to the gods. Much the same action produced that curious and impossible custom by which, even in their lifetime, the Roman Emperors were hailed as gods: Augustus Caesar prefixed Divus to his name, and thus added an hereditary title to the Caesarship. This did not mean that he was supposed immortal or incapable of wrong, but only that, as the highest symbol of the State, he became thereby worthy of worship. Foolish as it may seem in its expression, the idea was a noble one, and compares very favourably with the modern cynic who, parrot-like, declares politics to be a dirty business, and politicians to be only "on the make." What has happened to Christianity that it should seem to fall so considerably below the pagan ideal?

Certainly, then, there is this to be remembered, that the State was itself the object of religious worship. It was equivalent to the Church, and in consequence there could be no other moral code to come in conflict with it. The curious position achieved by Aristotle in his book on Politics is that he asks the question: Must a good citizen be a good man? Here, by the very form of the question, he does acknowledge really what he would not have done in theory, that there was a fixed law of ethics independent of the State; but as a Greek, he was bound to uphold the absolute fusion of the two. Now here Christianity has held an entirely different point of view; for while the State remained national, the Church became international, for it was based, not on ceremonies, but on doctrine; not on customs that are local, but on truth which is ubiquitous. Yet this did not produce any lowering influence on the view taken of national political life. Saint Paul and Saint Peter both taught subjection to Caesar, when Caesar meant Nero; and Saint Paul himself proudly boasted his Roman citizenship as his birthright. Again, the Church herself consecrated the forms of government, hallowed kings, sat in the seats of judgement, lent her bishops to the national council chambers, and championed freedom of election. Representative government is her gift to the West; so that it cannot be said that she has in her teaching neglected politics. Indeed, the accusation is made often against her that she dabbled too much in politics.

How, then, if the attitude of the Church has been to make sacred the forms of political life, has the result of her contact with the world been to create the cynical distrust of all public men? Perhaps the reason for my suspicious view of such men is the very contrary of this: not that the Church has lowered politics, but because politics have excluded the Church, because they and I have been too anxious to keep religion out of politics. There is always a natural idea that religion loses enormously from being entangled in party strife; but though that may be perfectly true in many ways, it is equally false when it is made to apply not only to the mere party squabbles, but to the whole domain of government and the national life: for religion stands to lose if it remains simply in the sacristy. The Church must play her part in the defence of justice, whether in politics or economics or abstract truth. Now, by the Church and religion are not meant simply the clergy; the Church is the whole assembly of the faithful. Catholics who denounce modern politicians are often to blame for the low ebb (if it is a low ebb) of political life. Faith alone and the supernatural value of life can give reverence and dignity to government; and to say that a thing is evil and therefore to refuse any further commerce with it does not tend to make the evil become good. Let me, therefore, go back to my life, conscious that my duties of citizenship are duties that a Catholic should be eager to discharge. Men crowd in time of war to the defence of the State; why not also in time of peace? Let me not dread the loss of time that may be occasioned by local patriotism, convinced that in rendering to Caesar the things that are Caesar's I am rendering also to God the things that are God's.



As men, we don't have the right to wave away the necessity of the political in establishing the reign of Christ the King.

Integralism is not Interpretive Cont.

Continued from Page 2

sphere of general ideas in which we have placed the question up to now, and let us focus on the very particular point of view in which our opponents place themselves.

They are not our adversaries, nor can they be, of that *essential and absolute integralism* which is the very being of God. Nor are they opponents of the *participatory and relative integralism* which constitutes the virtues and perfection of His saints. Nor do they recoil from *commercial integralism*, nor do they find *the integralism of the magistracy* absurd, nor do they denounce as folly *the integralism of military discipline*, nor do they even defame or mock the simple and customary integralism of *honorable husbands and fathers of families.* Indeed, if any one of them is found in any of these latter categories, he receives great praise for it and is rightly called a *perfect and complete integralist.* All of this they find very good and very well adjusted to reason, and very consistent with sound logic. All of these integralisms our adversaries regard as *pearls.*

Only, what astonishment! They reserve their righteous indignation and their terrible anathemas for *one other integralism*, which is precisely the *fundamental and essential one*, without which all the other integralism's they so admire come crashing miserably down, lacking the foundation upon which all the other integralists of which we have mentioned up to now. Yes, my lords, the integralism they abhor and continually denounce is the *Integralism of the Social rights of Christ the King*, the integralism of His divine sovereignty over States as well as over individuals. To preach this integralism, to defend it at all costs, to propagate it by every means, this is our sin, this is what formal denunciation is made against us at all hours, and it is for this reason that a rigorous sentence is being pursued against us. One would think that Christ-God and His Gospel have no right to be respected in the integrity of their divine claims, whereas the laws of the market or of the Stock Exchange, the laws of the military Code or the Ordinance, or simply the most common and familiar natural honesty, do have that right!



The *Labarum:* symbol of Emporer Constantine

The Logical Foundation

This exception they make against the integralist rights of religious-social truth — while on the other hand they show themselves perfectly willing to respect the integralist rights of all the other integralisms' mentioned above, is all the more unjustifiable and absurd in every way, when one considers the idea we have just pointed out and which we will now allow ourselves to develop with somewhat greater breadth.

We have said that the integralism of the social rights of God and of His Holy Church is what we might call *fundamental integralism.* This is the base, soul, and life of all the other subordinate integralisms, and without it they have no rational foundation. It is therefore ridiculous and illogical to maintain every other public or private integrity in the relations of citizens among themselves, if the integrity of the rights of the law of God and His Church, mocked today by the liberal and transactional school under the name of *Integralism*, is not first well established as an inconceivable principle. Say what one will about it, discuss it from whatever angle one pleases, it is eternal, incontestable, and fundamental in sound philosophy. *It will always be the truth that all human rights, however respectable they may be, derive from the recognition of a supreme divine right.*

If there is no God, or if I do not feel the obligation to recognize and bow to His authority in all its extension, then neither is there any man who can exercise over me the slightest degree of authority, nor anyone to whom I owe recognition of it. And if this authority of God can be contested by human creatures, or mutilated in deference to human interests and passing conveniences, or disregarded whenever it does not conform to the particular criterion or inclination of each individual, then I see no reason whatsoever why my free will should not apply the same standard to all other authorities of inferior order.

There is no reason why the rights of commercial integralism (the Commercial Code), judicial integralism (the Law of Civil Procedure), military integralism (Military Regulations), or domestic integralism (Conjugal Fidelity) should be treated differently. Those who reject integralism in the order of God's social rights cannot logically embrace it in the order of man's social rights. Either they must renounce these human and subordinate integralisms, or they must accept that fundamental and divine integralism as well. The only escape from this dilemma is inconsistency.

I do not believe our opponents will accept such an inconsistency as a valid retreat, one that amounts to nothing less than the complete loss of dignity in this controversy.

The Crisis of the Age: Nihilism vs. Integralism

Today more than ever, these considerations are of great importance, for today more than ever, the Revolution tends toward radicalism, and therefore all counter-revolutionary reaction must also tend toward radicalism. Self-interest, compromise, love of personal convenience, these try as much as possible to favor and prolong the reign of half-measures, which, as in every period of transition, has prevailed for the last hundred years. This era of half-measures is coming to an end, my lords. Let us bless God and ask Him that it end as soon as possible.

We have already arrived at the beginning of the end, and very soon it will be necessary to accept Liberalism with all its harshest consequences. *The final word of European Liberalism is radical to the extreme, and of a crudeness without equal. It is called Nihilism.*

"Now then: against this absolute negation, what can be better opposed than an absolute affirmation? Against that audacious *nothing* of the Revolution, what other decisive answer can be given but the *everything* of Christian Restoration?"

Note this well: it is no longer merely a matter of withholding rights from God in the name of a false emancipation of man; nor is it merely a matter of counterbalancing the absolute rights of divine sovereignty with the so-called rights of man. No, the problem is faced head-on, and the answer is: *nothing* of God in social organization; *nothing* of God in the regime of the family; *nothing* of God as the foundation and safeguard of property; *nothing* of God as the source and rule of morality; *nothing* of God as the principle and end of the human soul; *nothing* of God as hope for the next life and as a bridle upon the present one.

Nothing! This word is short but comprehensive, and worth a hundred programs. It is the blank slate of Liberalism, its epilogue and definitive consequence, frightful yes, but logical and rational, of all its preceding negations.

This, my lords, is Nihilism.

Now then: against this absolute negation, what can be better opposed than an absolute affirmation? Against that audacious *nothing* of the Revolution, what other decisive answer can be given but the *everything* of Christian restoration?

Why not say, in an analogous manner: *all the rights of God, in everything — all the rights of God, with all their applications and all their consequences?*

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Our Clock was Slow

Young Man of Character

Bishop Tihamer Toth

A man arrives at the railway station out of breath: "I have to catch the express train to Vienna!" "It has just left" he hears the answer. "Terrible! What will happen now? I should have made it! This is a disaster!" laments the frustrated passenger. But he has no right to complain: The train was on time, but he was not. Just as in life in general: Things in life are always exactly on time, it is people who are late.

What is the meaning of punctuality? It is very simple: Stop everything immediately when its time is past, and start everything immediately when its time has arrived. If you obey this simple rule, you accomplish everything you have to, and do so on time. Being punctual starts early in the morning. It is time to get up: say six a.m. Realize: the time for rest has passed, so jump out of bed. If you do so, you will not have to complain: I am sorry, but I had no time to pray this morning.

The time for studying has arrived. What an advantage if you can be punctual now, if you can realize that you have to act because its time has arrived, instead of stretching for half an hour and counting your buttons: start, not start, study, not study… If one is punctual, he does not forget his book and notebook when starting out for school; when he returns, he does not throw his things around the room so that later he shall have to apologize: "I do not know where I put them."

Punctuality! Such an unpretentious word, yet an inconceivably important means of forming character. To do our duty hundreds of times every day as demanded by our work; to be conscientious even in small things; to put our soul into our work even when nobody looks and sees it; is there a more effective means of developing moral greatness and becoming a whole man? According to the famous saying: Punctuality is the politeness of kings. Truly, we need a royal quality, greatness, courage, heroic perseverance to overcome obstacles and respond when duty calls so that we never evade it, and never try to find excuses for doing so.

We can trust one with the great tasks of life only if he is always in everything punctual. A punctual young man even has more money in his pocket even though he may get less money from home than the one who is always late. What is the explanation? The punctual lad spends it only when it is essential and buys what he got it for. The other, by contrast, buys everything he runs into in the stores.

Whoever values time is always punctual. If he does not make others wait for him, he shows thereby that he values the time of others just as much as his own. On the other hand, if someone is inexact and disorderly in the beginning, he gradually becomes untruthful and unreliable; if someone cannot be trusted with time, we assume he cannot be trusted with anything.

If someone is inexact, we cannot trust his word, and such a man harms society as much as an anarchist or revolutionary. On the other hand, the one who is punctual and exact has demonstrated his reliability, his will power, his character. It is very much part of good character to stick to your words once you said yes or no.

"Please, teacher Sir, our clock was slow," the student who is late excuses himself. When in fact he should say: "Please, teacher Sir, I was negligent and disorderly–that is why I am late."

"Our clock was slow!" Do you know what George Washington answered to one of his clerks who excused himself this way? "Either you get another clock, or I get myself another clerk."

There is much truth in the words of Lord Nelson: "I owe all my success in life to having been always a quarter of an hour before my time."



Punctuality, one of the easiest ways to demonstrate one's pedigree!

Integralism is not Interpretive Cont.

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More clearly: if today the Revolution proclaims itself, and already is, nihilism, what must the true counter-revolution be but *integralism?*

A Call to Wake Up

I am astonished, and I cannot see how the whole world does not see it in this way, and that there should be so many clear minds and good hearts, whom we have every reason to suppose are well-intentioned, who are blinded and seduced (as we so often see, to our sorrow) by the false attractions of that old, worn-out, and discredited *moderatism.*

It will come to pass, much to their dismay, that one day these blessed souls will awaken from their dream, blind through convenience and deaf through willfulness, for they neither see nor wish to hear what appears so clearly on the social horizon, and what the fixed and sure signs of our times so plainly mark out for *Catholic Propaganda.*



Pope Pius IX, a defender of Catholic orthodoxy and sound doctrine. One of his crowning documents, The *Syllabus of Errors*, reads as an introduction to Integralism, at least from the theological perspective.

Ah, my lords! Let us for once open our eyes to the glare of the fire that is already being prepared to illuminate us from Hell; let us apply an attentive ear to the no-longer-distant but now immediate roar of the hurricane that threatens to engulf us; and if even that good fortune should not in the end spare us from the perversity of the revolutionary plague, at least let us be forewarned and on our guard.

For that very reason, those Catholics who, in the face of the gravity of this social crisis, unlike anything seen in past centuries, recoil from the alarm raised by Catholic radicalism, calling it exaggerated, and oppose the defensive strategies of integralism, dismissing it as no less dangerous than the radicalism of the demagogue, those Catholics, I say, are *more ruinous than the Revolution itself,* and if they act consciously, they are more criminal than the revolutionaries themselves.

Ah! Our enemies have also hit the mark this time with that word, and in that too we must do justice to their happy inventiveness and the precise aptness of their dictionary. Yes, it is true, we are disturbers, and to disturb, to be restless, and to be troublesome to excess is our integralism.

Disturbers of the false peace which the children of this century long for as their supreme happiness; *disturbers* of the wretched idleness of flesh and blood, which today, as they have always done, shun the hardships of Christian combat; *disturbers* of sleeping consciences, of sluggish hearts, of deadened energies, just as the friendly voice that warns the careless traveler of the nearness of the abyss is a disturber, or as the cautery or the revulsive that burns the skin of the torpid patient to restore his sensation and give him back his life is a disturber.

The half-hearted Catholic does well to call us that, but perhaps he does not notice the service he thereby renders to the fierce revolutionary beast, of which he thus makes himself the best ally and helper. For in reality, *an accomplice of the thief* seems to be the one who, seeing him force the door, does not cry out loudly and does not raise the alarm, so as not to disturb the peaceful rest of the master of the house; and *an accomplice of the arsonist* seems to be the one who, seeing the first flames of the fire, does not break out crying: *Fire! Fire!,* for fear of disturbing the peace of the neighborhood with his cries.

Ah! My lords, *the house is burning on all four sides*, and yet we are expected not to cry out, nor even sound the alarm whistle? Everything is being invaded, devastated, and plundered by a fierce irruption of new fat Barbary raiders, and yet it is claimed that the better course is to *pretend not to see*, so that the alarm may not disturb the *blessed peace of those who are sleeping?* Call that prudence if you will, call it moderation, call it the desire to avoid a greater evil, in the language of plain common sense among all peoples, it has never been called anything other than *treason or cowardice.*

Conclusion: Spain and the Integralist Banner

Be not traitors to the holy banner of the integral social rights of God, be not cowards in their defense — you who wish to be my friends and fervent members of this religious Academy.

More than anywhere else, *integralism has taken deep root in our nation*, because less than in any other nation are disloyalty and cowardice known in *Spain.* This blessed ideal has its apostles today in every nation on the globe, where under this same or a similar epithet it is mocked and derided by the Revolution and by those who are complacent toward it. France has them, Switzerland has them, Belgium has them, Germany and Austria and Italy and England have them — our sister republics of the American continent have them, at the head of which *Ecuador* has caused this banner to fly, stained with the blood of *García Moreno,* who died for it.

"This blessed ideal has its apostles today in every nation on the globe, where under this same or a similar epithet it is mocked and derided by the Revolution and by those who are complacent toward it."

But believe this: if in every one of these nations there remained not a single soldier faithful to the integral sovereignty of Christ Our Lord, *there would still be many left in this His faithful Spain*, where with greater splendor than in any other nation it has reigned in past centuries, and where with more veneration than anywhere else on the globe He has promised to reign again.

And if, through our sins, even in this privileged land there should one day come to be completely swept away the integrally Catholic spirit by the ill-fated liberal or transactionist current, *doubt it not*, the death of Catholic integralism in Spain would be the death of our vigorous nationality itself, and the last Spaniard truly worthy of that name would be the last *integralist.*

Rejection of the Rule of Law In Favour of Rule by Law When Authority Decides Good and Evil

Mr T.S. Bell

Mr Bell is a member of The Legio Filiorum Sancti Philippi Neri*—The Legion of the Sons of Saint Philip Neri, a Catholic young men's group committed to the spiritual, intellectual and physical formation of its members so as to establish the Kingship of Christ in Britain.*

Now, prior to the Reformation, the Sovereign was subjected to the fundamental and constitutional obligation to Magna Carta and their coronation oath. The Protestant Monarchs and thereafter Parliament, captured the Natural Law of God and the Common Law of man, in order that their contents could be perversely transmuted to serve the will of the State. Now we can see plainly that Parliament has done away with its bastardized version of God's Law and will soon do the same with the Common Law of man.

Secondly, the Reformation laid out the carpet for the "harm principle": that, essentially, the only purpose for which power can be rightfully exercised over any member of a civilized community against his will is to prevent harm to others. This principle means that civic power does not extend to the saving of the souls of others.

Harm is, however, a vague term. Is it physical? Is it psychological? Is it to the individual? Or is it to the community? This is how backsliding to pagan morality can be achieved: by the changing of legal principles and definitions to the point where harm done by offensive words outweighs the damage of public immorality.

We may also see the abandonment of God in another philosophical framework, that facilitated by the Reformation: that of Utilitarianism, wherein the maximisation of happiness and minimisation of suffering is a litmus test for a good law in our nation. Note that happiness after earth is not included here. Thus, this form of hedonism can be used to justify abortion, suicide and now, according to the Greens, a complete decriminalization of drugs. This moral system once applied to humans only, is now being applied to animals and to trees, who, according to some, should be entitled to human rights apparently.

All of this begs a question, why have we done this to ourselves as a nation? This is simply because we have loved the world more than we have loved Our Lord. Whilst the Faith's glories are unseen, the attractions of the world are before our eyes. The issue being that the world can promise us far more than it can fulfill. The Reformation promised to the nobility old and grand estates. The Enlightenment promised to middling men, that for scientific advancement, they must cast off the notion of God altogether. And now they preach the Gospel of equality to minority groups to foster the final collapse of our society.

The final law is the one that we tell ourselves that God has abandoned our nation. But this is completely inverse. We have rejected God and the consequence has been the scourging of this United Kingdom. And only by drawing closer to the Faith, may we reclaim our birthright, which is peace and true freedom in these isles.

Now Cardinal Newman explains by four duties how we may achieve reclamation of this birthright. The first duty is intercession: constant prayer for the State and all in authority, no matter the persecution of the Church. This secures all other duties: candour, respect, not speaking evil of dignities and bars disgust and misanthropy. The second duty mentioned is remonstrance: calm, distinct, persevering; by word, look and demeanor. Layman, especially legal professionals, have a deep responsibility as the machinery of change passes through their hands. The third duty is submission and order: "The powers that be ordained of God, whether they foster the true Church or not, the more loyal, affection mingled with obedience, the better."

The fourth duty that the Cardinal talks about, is resigning oneself to daily, hourly duties of piety, purity, charity, and justice. Doing all as a Christian credits the cause and draws down God's blessing. This fosters punctuality, veracity, fairness, impartiality, patience, and an awful sense of God's presence.

In the Era of Modernism, that we now live in, a fifth duty must be added to this protocol. That being an increased devotion to the Blessed Virgin Mary, through the recitation of the rosary, for all the sacrileges and indifferences committed in our nation every waking minute. Our Lady is our only hope in saving this United Kingdom. Only through her intercession may we be delivered from our present sadness in the tyranny of the current regime; just like the Austrians who were delivered from the grasp of this communist Soviet Union by an increase in devotion to Our Lady.

The Emblem of the LFSPN

The Legion *can be reached at t.me/LFSPN_Media for membership enquiries.*

The Old Urbanism: Part II

Why Without it a Truly Integral Catholic Culture is Absolutely Impossible

Josue Hernandez

Continuing from the front-page article of The Plough*'s July 2026 issue.*

Agrarian or Urban?

But a bold peasantry, their country's pride, When once destroyed, can never be supplied. A time there was, 'ere England's griefs began, When every rood of ground maintained its man; Wor him light labour spread the wholesome store, Just gave what life required, but gave no more; His best companions, innocence and health; And his best riches, ignorance of wealth. But times are alter'd; trade's unfeeling train Usurp the land and dispossess the swain;

— The Deserted Village, Oliver Goldsmith

Let us go into the fields
— Canticle of Canticles

Deep within the Catholic milieu, ever since the industrialization of the city that resulted in the forced displacement of the traditional peasantry, there has lingered the important question regarding a return to a life lived on and rooted in the land. Agriculture, what Pius VII termed *"the first and most important of all the arts"* has always been a central and prominent feature of every healthy society. In addition to providing for the necessary physical sustenance of a people, the agrarian life fosters a sense of stewardship towards the God-given natural world that man has been called to till and order, as well as a deep-seated love of place, the preservation of memory, a respect for custom and tradition, and an acute awareness of our absolute dependence on the Creator of all things.

A false notion has, however, arisen, that if one is to escape the noise and chaos and altogether moral degeneracy of the modern city, while avoiding the dullness of the suburb, in pursuit of the peace and simplicity of agrarian life, then one must necessarily embrace a life of social isolation within some remote rural setting. The vision of the family farm we tend to hold in our imaginations is that of the single family homestead. *The Little House on the Prairie*, as it were, with Ma and Pa and the children banding together to meet the challenges of frontier life in their little lone cabin on the plains. To be sure, beautiful and heartfelt scenes of family life are bound to ensue within such an environment of common work. There too, amidst the elemental world of nature, in which the consequent strengthening of family ties would result in exquisite moments of shared leisure and recreation, a life of prayer would be facilitated and nurtured by the rhythm of the seasons and the witnessing of the wonders of creation.

These blessings are, without question, all to be greatly desired. But such benefits do not come about as a result of distancing oneself from the embrace of neighbors, extended family and friends. On the contrary, they form part of an abundant harvest of spiritual goods that is meant to be generously shared with others. And although the pre-conditions of a vibrant culture can be diligently nurtured within the family, it can never be produced within the realm of the single household. The colorful tapestry of culture can only be successfully woven by a larger community of families, by a commonwealth.[1] Our model should not be the isolated homestead of the American frontier but, rather, the European hamlet and village—even town and city—of former Christendom.

The village (and its smaller counterpart, the hamlet) is essentially a small, physically coherent, if spontaneously and perhaps somewhat haphazardly developed, community of farmers living in close proximity to one another and sharing together in common spaces such as the village green, the common land, and the parish church. Within it, we already see the seedbed of urbanism, which is simply the successively larger and more complex ordering of social life that finds its fulfillment in the self-sufficiency of the city[2]. And although the village, whose function and purpose is essentially agrarian, forms a desperately needed counterweight to the dismal asphalt jungles that make up our industrialized civilization, we should, nevertheless, not allow ourselves to fall prey to the modern temptation of shunning the town and city as such.

To this very day one can visit the old continent and in many places still visually witness the close-knit, symbiotic relationship between urban and agrarian life in a landscape sprinkled with picturesque small towns and densely packed villages entirely encompassed by the fields and pastures of their small farms. Even with regards to the city, this intimate relationship often holds true, as is experienced firsthand by those who routinely enjoy leisurely afternoon walks to and from some such urban centers. At the northern end of Spain, where my family and I have been temporarily residing for a time, there's a region called Asturias, known for its vast green pastures and consequent dairy farming—as well as its rugged coastline and Celtic culture that often make for more of a striking resemblance to the isle of Éire than to the rest of the neighboring regions on the peninsula. In its capital city of Oviedo one can, as I have, commence a delightful stroll beneath the spires of its awe-inspiring Gothic cathedral situated at its center and within half an hour (after experiencing little to no sprawl) find oneself quite suddenly in the middle of the countryside.

To further illustrate this union, I'd point you to the fact that the ancient Greek term *polis*, meaning city, was understood to be composed of two parts, the *asty* (the urban center), which housed the political, military and religious institutions, as well as its main trading activities, and the *chora* (the countryside), with its collection of villages and farms. Each of these, the urban center and the countryside, although distinct, came together to form the larger organism that we know as the city, with the *chora* comprising the majority of the population. Such is the closely bound relationship between urbanism and the land that was, until quite recently, the universal norm.

This, however, also brings us to the critical question of scale and size. Contrary to what has become our common experience through a seemingly endless, directionless and shapeless mess that is urban sprawl, the city—like the town, the neighborhood and the village—has an orienting center that simultaneously manifests both its spatial as well as cultural reference points (e.g. the church, the square, the school, the library, the theater, the courthouse, City Hall, etc.), from which extends a radius of urban development.

Naturally, the length of this radius is the result of what, on average, would be considered a convenient distance to one's daily needs—with the neighborhood (being the smallest and most immediate unit and thus having to supply for our most immediate necessities) having a span of about a five-minute walk.[3] Quite significant for our sense of spatial orientation is the fact that along the radius of the town and city the building density gradually dissipates as it moves away from the center and outward towards the encompassing villages, farms, and eventual wilderness. This perceivable gradation and demarcation gives the particular urban settlement its defined size and shape making it not only unique but distinguishable from its immediate surroundings, forming, consequently, a rather stark contrast to the visual blur of sprawl.

Certainly, the proper proportions of scale have been gravely violated in almost everything we now see around us. Not to mention that, at least according to Plato, the ideal city maxes out at a population of 5,040 households. The City ought to be limited in numbers such that its members will be able to recognize one another, but it must be large enough to ensure its defense and assist allied cities.[4] Apart from the more obvious question of territorial scale, whatever the proper mean may actually be in terms of density, there is no question that it was, long ago, grossly exceeded; with it were destroyed also the natural bonds of community, neighborhood identity, and local culture which consequently have us now reaping the costly rewards of societal disintegration.

The Pascua Project

Oh Pascua, my heart turns to thee, And ponders thy proud land, Trustful haven true and free, Where we make our last stand, Hispania, bright Christendom! Runs through thy streams and soil, Where holy martyrs, blood flowed from, To crown thee true and royal…

"Our model should not be the isolated homestead of the American frontier but, rather, the European hamlet and village—even town and city—of former Christendom."

— Pascua In Our Hearts (The Proud Floridian's Last Stand)

Though you, Florida, abound in violets and acanthus, your flourish cannot match that of your martyr.
— Fr. Gerard Montanus, S.J. (1584-1632)

In the summer of 2020, amidst the chaos and uncertainty of that unhappy time, my family having lost its longstanding business and I, having just learned that my wife was expecting our first child, with no source of income and unable to afford a house, set out to build a town.

The idea may sound a bit rash, perhaps mad even. It all came about rather suddenly, as did much of the unexpected strangeness that occurred in those days. Of course, who hasn't, at some point, dreamt of thumbing his nose at Mordor and building his own bastion of sanity amidst the confused mayhem of modern life? Returning to the Shire, as it were. Or, as in our case, restoring it. For me, founding a settlement had always been on the long list of things that I would do if my retirement plan of winning the Powerball ever panned out, but it was merely a faint hope and dream. Not the kind of thing one would actually attempt to do without everything first neatly and comfortably falling onto one's lap.

Perhaps things did, indeed, fall onto my lap, but just not at all in the way that would be expected. Jobless, with the family business now gone and in the hands of a bad business partner, but, luckily, with a little bit of savings in the bank, I did what any new father feeling the weight of the world on his shoulders would do and quickly set out to find a way to provide for

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A Dutch setting showing a proportioned urbanisim built around a church.

The Old Urbanism: Part II Cont.

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my new family's future. Like many at that time, my instinct was to flee the city, seeing that the cities were more and more each day coming to resemble the totalitarian despotisms we had all become so familiar with through our books of 20th-century history and popular dystopian sci-fi novels.

My brilliant plan had been to leave Miami and purchase a small plot of land of an acre or two out in the middle of rural Florida to then have it turned into a small community of tiny homes organized in such a way so as to resemble that of a small village having aesthetically pleasing, thoughtfully planned common areas and doing everything possible to keep it from looking like the planned cookie cutter suburb that has, tragically, become so emblematic of much of my beloved Florida. In effect, I was looking to create what amounted to a glorified trailer park. A major concern at the time, as now, was the problem of housing affordability. Like countless others of my generation, home ownership was quickly becoming unattainable for me. If my grand scheme worked out, it would give me, and others like me, a feasible way of owning a decent, if very small, home within a pleasant setting.

As Providence would have it, however, one fateful morning after attending mass I was confronted with the bold question that catalyzed what would come to be known as the Pascua Project. Amidst casual conversation with my good friend and classically trained architect, Philip Rhea, I began to describe my desperate plan as he listened and commiserated with me about my current situation. We discussed things at length while he fed me valuable advice until eventually, noticeably underwhelmed by my enthusiastic endeavor, he turned to me and asked: "Instead of a trailer park, why don't you just build a town?"

Why not just build a town? It turns out that, besides being broke and lacking any experience, I couldn't really come up with a good answer. Why not, indeed? And just like that, the effort to realize *Pascua* was born.



An English village: capturing the perfect harmony of rural development.

Philip and I set to work immediately and tirelessly. There was so much to consider, so much to study and learn. So many people to reach out to. I spent every weekend for the better part of the next two years, and sometimes much more, on the road scouting properties across the state. Finding friends along the way that I could stay with. At times I took my wife and newborn son along, sometimes I even convinced my parents to hop in the car with us. It was a wild adventure. Gradually we built up a small team made up of a couple of passionate amateur small farmers, an urban planner, an incredible real estate agent willing to go above and beyond the call of duty, a few close friends, and a very generous and energetic real estate lawyer with all the experience in raising funds that we lacked. Some of us were already good friends while others became so along the way. We all jumped headfirst into the project, and slowly our vision began to take shape.

Pascua, the name of our proposed settlement, was taken as a homage to Florida's Spanish Catholic roots. Christened by our Christian forebears as Pascua Florida, meaning Flowery Easter, upon first sighting her shores on Easter Sunday, 1513, our state would become home to the oldest European settlement in North America, Saint Augustine, and with it the site of the first celebration of the Holy Sacrifice of the Mass on our continent. Bedewed by the blood of many now sadly forgotten martyrs, the state boasts a surprising and dramatic, if somewhat short-lived, history of unyielding fidelity to the Faith and Holy Mother Church. Taking inspiration from this ignored, and all too often intentionally suppressed, inheritance, we proposed to plant our flag in this land of our faithful forefathers.

Among some of our most pressing concerns with regard to the project has been how to avoid the abysmal failure that is often associated with the creation of intentional communities. Common commitment and intentionality, even a shared liturgical life, although absolutely essential (and, in the case of liturgy, central), are, in the end, no substitute for practical functionality. Lacking any sort of robust economic foundation such as a shared profitable enterprise that joins common work to individual sustenance, a tight network of small farms and cottage industries, the operation of a school or university and the necessary goods and services that come along with it, or any other such cornerstones of practical social cohesion, a community will wither and at length die or else have to be propped up on life support through some extrinsic means of sustenance that is alien and ultimately opposed to its natural flourishing.

> "Of course, who hasn't, at some point, dreamt of thumbing his nose at Mordor and building his own bastion of sanity amidst the confused mayhem of modern life?"

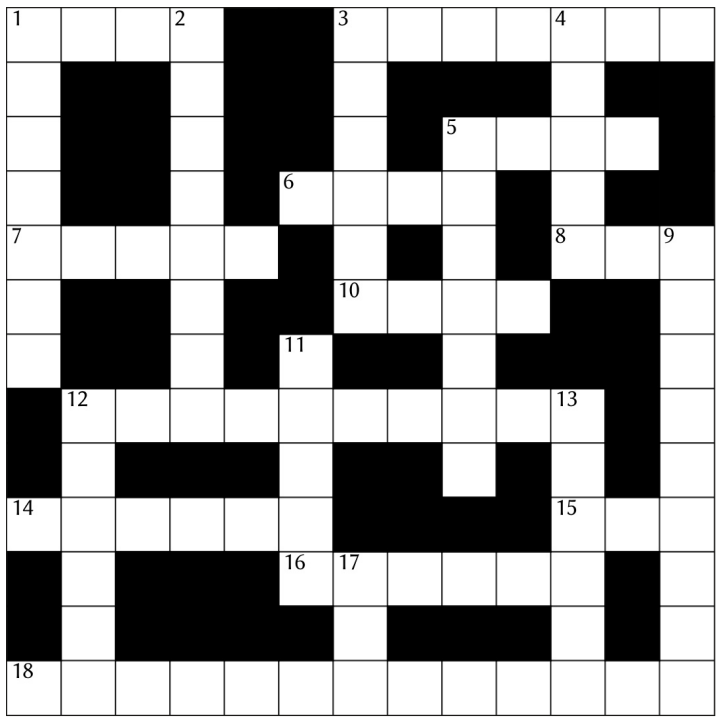
I believe that this is a key lesson that can be taken from other intentional communities and is what consistently means the difference between failure or success. A group of remote workers playing at homesteading on the weekends, however enthusiastic or large in number, cannot sustainably generate the necessary social capital for a properly functioning and economically viable community.[5] This is the great challenge we must confront in our nomadic age of increasingly abstract and disconnected modes of work in which the tradesman, the small farmer and the modest owner of real productive property are each day becoming more of an endangered species.

The road to Pascua has, thus far, been long and winding, consisting of many fits and starts, and has been anything but straightforward. Full of surprises, both good and bad, it is proving to be a rich and immersive learning experience showcasing just how wrong and backwards everything in modern society is. How the most basic and fundamental things in life like community, small businesses and a local economy; access to clean, non-poisonous food; and even just simple human shelter, to name a few, are directly under attack by a cold and ruthless bureaucratic state; large, usurious financial institutions; enormous corporations and the insidious ideology of Liberalism that have all laid a violent

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PUZZLES FOR THE LETTERED FOLK

CROSSWORD



Across

1) An organised match to the death between two men. Outlawed by The Church (4)
3) An ancient Roman military standard that displayed the Chi-Rho symbol (7)
5) Famous British explorer (4)
6) A Roman Emperor (4)
7) From Old English meaning old person (5)
8) To consume food (3)
10) Alexander cut this thing in half in order to demonstrate that decisive action solves problems(4)
12) Something that is dependent on another (10)
14) Region of Scotland associated with the Campbells (6)
15) Paddle used to propel a water-bourne vessel (3)
16) A sum paid to return something taken unjustly (6)
18) The English Civil War which saw the rise of the Tudor dynasty (3-2-3-5)

Down

1) Greek word meaning organisation, name of a bishop's territory (7)
2) Follower of the heretical sect of Luther (8)
3) City in the North of Germany associated with the Merchant guilds in the Middle Ages (6)
4) River in France (5)
9) Discovered by St Helena (4-5)
11) Tiber, Thames, Seine, Tyne, Rhine, Humber, Po, Danube etc (5)
13) Author of the Summa (6)
17) Species of tree (3)

CALTROP SWEEPER

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				4			3					
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The Old Urbanism: Part II Cont.

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stranglehold on the way of life of the average American.

I've experienced firsthand just how difficult it is to discuss a noble, and even desperately needed, undertaking—especially one having to do with real estate, and real estate in Florida, at that—outside the framework of a Liberal economic order where everything is reduced to a mere commodity, and how absolutely essential something at least akin to a functioning aristocracy with a deep-seated sense of *noblesse oblige* and self-sacrifices to the development and preservation of any kind of healthy and properly ordered society. In effect, I've come to realize how simply coming to the defense of the most ordinary things in life is in fact the most radical and extraordinary gesture one can make in this topsy-turvy world of ours.

Two years after that momentous conversation with Philip, our small, ragtag group of intrepid *reconquistadores* (or aspiring "real estate developers", as those with impoverished imaginations and no clue of what we're trying to accomplish may be tempted to call us) found itself in a meeting with, arguably, New Urbanism's most well-known founder, as well as the movement's greatest exponent, Andrés Duany. Sitting in his Little Havana office, we went over the details of our grand multi-generational project as we drank deep from the font of wisdom of a true pioneer and master of his craft. It speaks volumes about his, and his wonderful team members', dedication to the success of the movement that on multiple occasions they have been willing to put aside time in order to meet and seriously discuss our perhaps overly ambitious musings. To have been given such an opportunity has been truly humbling and we will forever be grateful for such generosity.

Soon after the memorable meeting with Andrés, we discovered our first serious prospective property. The plan was to see if we could negotiate what would have to be a very creative deal, being that the cash we had on hand was not exactly impressive when facing off with a property of more than 400 acres in Florida at the height of probably the greatest real estate boom in all the annals of history. Nevertheless, we decided to throw caution to the wind and go for it. All but two of the dedicated Pascua families, (who lived out of state and weren't able to make the trip) showed up at that beautiful and overlooked corner of North Florida one June morning.

There were many minivans and lots of kids that day. When we arrived on the property the two sisters who owned the land came to warmly greet us all in typical Southern fashion as one of our number stood at the back of his Honda Odyssey preparing Mint Juleps for everyone, which had been jokingly requested in passing: fresh mint, crushed ice, along with the best bourbon in the land were all dutifully brought along and put on offer for all—with the appropriate drinking glasses, of course, I might add. Thankfully, probably by some miracle of Providence, the sisters didn't find this gesture in any way peculiar or abnormal (or a combination of both rude and completely insane, as would have been understandable). Instead, they seemed rather charmed and amused and even offered their kitchen for greater ease in concocting the cocktails.

It was a wonderful morning and afternoon as we got to know and talk to the two women whose father had purchased the property generations earlier, after returning from fighting in the Second World War, and turned the multiple parcels into profitable ferneries. We all got along quite well and bonded over the course of that typical Florida summer day that kept threatening to pour on us. Which it, of course, eventually did, forcing us all to take refuge in one of the houses on the property.

In the end, the sisters were not impressed by our offer—nor by the financial acrobatics that came along with it. Lesser people might have expressed offense. Thankfully, they were good sports about it all and even entertained a few more discussions on the matter after the fact. Still, I dream about that land and its grand old moss-covered trees in that neglected and forgotten-by-time bucolic setting. In fact, I still hold out some hope that it may yet one day bear the name Pascua and that we will once again imbibe mint juleps under the shade of its live oaks – perhaps even by retrofitting that land's already existing adjacent small town, or some other yet unforeseen scenario. As with so much else, that remains to be seen as we continue to move ahead in earnest along this journey of discovery and promise.

The Grand Adventure of Our Times

Flee, for God's sake, flee from the sapped ramparts of success. Go home to the ruined neighborhoods and villages of your childhood and rebuild them. They will accuse you of nostalgia. In Greek, nostalgia means "home-sickness." Our hearts have been pierced like the sad heart of Ruth, sick for home amid the alien corn. Contrary to the famous verse, home is something you have very much to deserve. In fact you must sacrifice your life for it.

— John Senior, The Restoration of Christian Culture

Be bold, but wary! Keep up your merry hearts, and ride to meet your fortune.

— Tom Bombadil, The Lord of the Rings

To build amidst civilizational collapse is the grand adventure we have been called to. Before us is the choice of either passively accepting a life of social and spiritual destitution amidst the ruins of a new and grotesque barbarism, or courageously embracing our vocations as the sons and daughters of the greatest and most noble cultural inheritance. If successful, this daring, almost unthinkable, recovery will, in turn, serve as our unabashed monument proclaiming Christ's Kingship over our land and people, over our homes, neighborhoods, nations and institutions, which, after lowering ourselves and turning to the Most High, will surely result in the sweet balm of heavenly grace condescending to bestow upon us its healing remedy, so that the broken and humbled bones of our society may, once more, rejoice.

Nevertheless, every possible natural impediment has been set before us on the harrowing path that lies ahead, which will form a veritable *via dolorosa* of continual setbacks and falls under the weight of a fierce and burdensome opposition. Tyrannical laws that violently resist the formation of community, dehumanizing and acidic technologies that continue to eat away at the little social and cultural capital that remains, a utilitarian and usurious economic order that forcibly uproots us and commodifies the most precious things in life out of existence, a raging war against our immemorial traditions and liturgy, a multifaceted and unrelenting assault on the family, are but a few of the attacks in which we find ourselves besieged by a ruthless and implacable enemy.

The challenge is, in fact, stark, with little to no hope of success, and failure seems the only imaginable outcome. The wise will, undoubtedly, look on with curious amusement at what they will likely refer to as mere impudent gestures of defiance proceeding from a wildly impractical and regressive minority. Yet, unbeknownst to the jeers and scoffs of a mocking world sluggishly dragging the wearisome weight of an unchallenged dominance is the fact that the Christian—that forsaken orphan of our vanquished civilization—silently caries a secret hope within him (an exhilarating knowledge, in fact) that with the darkness and failure of the humiliating defeat of death comes the ultimate triumph of resurrection.

So, then, let us cheerfully go out to our deaths with full hearts, amidst the brightness of song and the warm camaraderie of friendship, and be that vexing stumbling block and sign of contradiction to the hubris of a decrepit world—evermore quickly advancing towards the twilight of senility—that cannot understand that our final victory, our happy and unexpected revenge, will be the thundering laughter of our children.

"Before us is the choice of either passively accepting a life of social and spiritual destitution amidst the ruins of a new and grotesque barbarism, or courageously embracing our vocations as the sons and daughters of the greatest and most noble cultural inheritance."

Special thanks to Alejandro Selin without whose help I could never have written this.

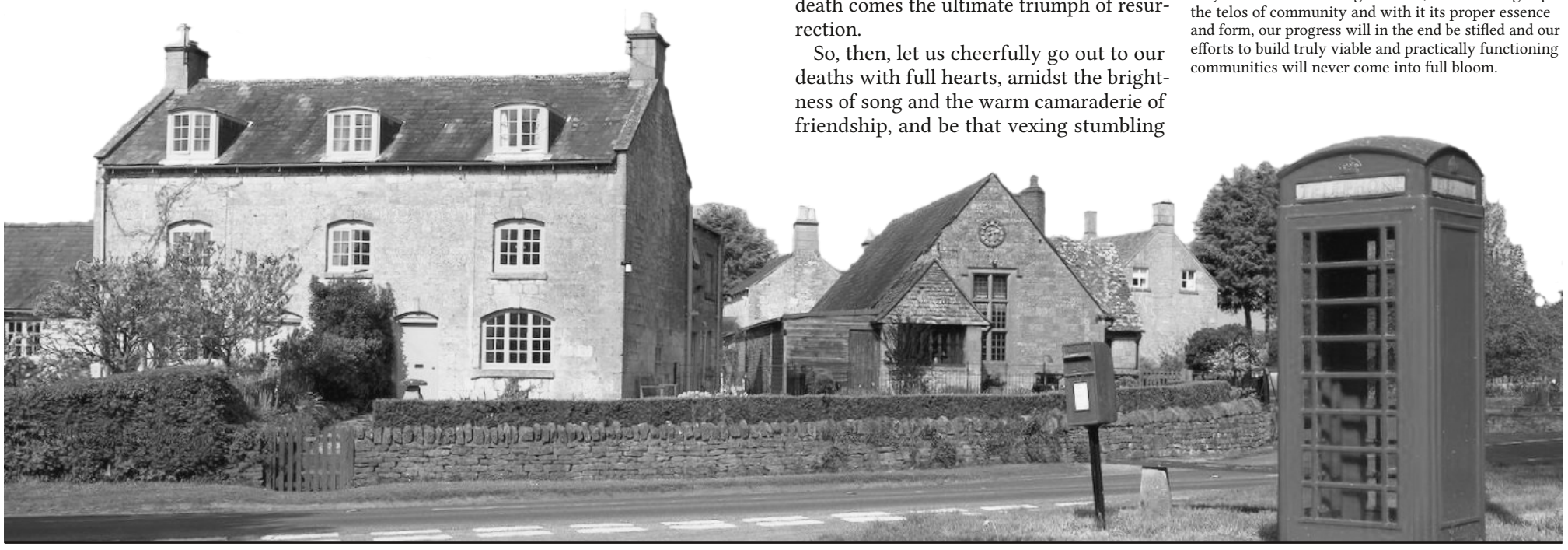
1. "The family is the association established by nature for the supply of men's everyday wants …But when several families are united, and the association aims at something more than the supply of daily needs, the first society to be formed is the village. …When several villages are united in a single complete community, large enough to be nearly or quite self-sufficing, the state comes into existence, originating in the bare needs of life, and continuing in existence for the sake of a good life." (Aristotle, Pol. I)

2. "[Aristotle] shows of what things the city is made up. For, just as a village is made up of several households, so a city is made up of several villages. Secondly, he says that the city is a perfect society; and this he proves from the fact that, since every association among all men is ordered to something necessary for life, that society will be perfect which is ordered to this: that man have sufficiently whatever is necessary for life. Such a society is the city. For it is of the nature of the city that in it should be found all the things that are sufficient for human life; and so it is. And for this reason it is made up of several villages, in one of which the art of the smith is practiced, in another the art of the weaver, and so of the others. Hence it is evident that the city is a perfect society. Thirdly, he shows to what the city is ordered. It is originally made for the sake of living, namely, that men might find sufficiently that from which they might be able to live; but from its existence it comes about that men not only live but that they live well, in so far as by the laws of the city the life of men is ordered to the virtues." (Aquinas, Pol. I, lect. 1, n. 23.)

3. Not to be confused with "The 15 Minute City". There has, of course, been an appropriation of the concept of "The 15 Minute City" by our technocratic oligarchs wherein they have manipulated the term to assist their pursued end of enslaving humanity. That being said, there is no doubt that our efforts to restore the principles of traditional urbanism will serve to oppose their nefarious agenda just as much, if not more than, eating red meat, having large families and generally being decent human beings who don't share their interest in cultivating intimate friendship with Satan.

4. Plato, Laws, 737d, 738e, 771e.

5. None of this is to say that greatly beneficial things cannot grow out of less than ideal arrangements. We cannot make the perfect the enemy of the good and must work with what we have. Better a real failure than a perfect fantasy. But our aim, nevertheless, should always be the proper ordering of things. The end is in the beginning, as the metaphysical principle goes. We must understand what we're trying to arrive at from the very outset. If we lose sight of this, if we fail to grasp the telos of community and with it its proper essence and form, our progress will in the end be stifled and our efforts to build truly viable and practically functioning communities will never come into full bloom.



Sermon on Women

Homily 9 on St Paul First Letter to St Timothy

St John Chrysostom

Wisdom from one of the Fathers of the Church, circa the 4th century.

"Let the women learn in silence with all subjection. But I suffer not a woman to teach, nor to usurp authority over the man, but to be in silence. For Adam was first formed, then Eve. And Adam was not deceived, but the woman being deceived was in the transgression. Notwithstanding she shall be saved in [through the] child-bearing, if they continue in faith and charity and holiness with sobriety."

Great modesty and great propriety does the blessed Paul require of women, and that not only with respect to their dress and appearance: he proceeds even to regulate their speech. And what says he? "Let the woman learn in silence"; that is, let her not speak at all in the church; which rule he has also given in his Epistle to the Corinthians, where he says, "It is a shame for women to speak in the church" (1 Corinthians 14:35); and the reason is, that the law has made them subject to men. And again elsewhere, "And if they will learn anything, let them ask their husbands at home." (1 Corinthians 14:35) Then indeed the women, from such teaching, kept silence; but now there is apt to be great noise among them, much clamor and talking, and nowhere so much as in this place. They may all be seen here talking more than in the market, or at the bath. For, as if they came hither for recreation, they are all engaged in conversing upon unprofitable subjects. Thus all is confusion, and they seem not to understand, that unless they are quiet, they cannot learn anything that is useful. For when our discourse strains against the talking, and no one minds what is said, what good can it do to them? To such a degree should women be silent, that they are not allowed to speak not only about worldly matters, but not even about spiritual things, in the church. This is order, this is modesty, this will adorn her more than any garments. Thus clothed, she will be able to offer her prayers in the manner most becoming.



Woman picking flowers.

"But I suffer not a woman to teach." "I do not suffer," he says. What place has this command here? The fittest. He was speaking of quietness, of propriety, of modesty, so having said that he wished them not to speak in the church, to cut off all occasion of conversation, he says, let them not teach, but occupy the station of learners. For thus they will show submission by their silence. For the sex is naturally somewhat talkative: and for this reason he restrains them on all sides. "For Adam," says he, "was first formed, then Eve. And Adam was not deceived, but the woman being deceived was in the transgression."

If it be asked, what has this to do with women of the present day? It shows that the male sex enjoyed the higher honor. Man was first formed; and elsewhere he shows their superiority. "Neither was the man created for the woman, but the woman for the man." (1 Corinthians 11:9) Why then does he say this? He wishes the man to have the preeminence in every way; both for the reason given above, he means, let him have precedence, and on account of what occurred afterwards. For the woman taught the man once, and made him guilty of disobedience, and wrought our ruin. Therefore because she made a bad use of her power over the man, or rather her equality with him, God made her subject to her husband. "Your desire shall be to your husband?" (Genesis 3:16) This had not been said to her before.

But how was Adam not deceived? If he was not deceived, he did not then transgress? Attend carefully. The woman said, "The serpent beguiled me." But the man did not say, The woman deceived me, but, "she gave me of the tree, and I did eat." Now it is not the same thing to be deceived by a fellow-creature, one of the same kind, as by an inferior and subordinate animal. This is truly to be deceived. Compared therefore with the woman, he is spoken of as "not deceived." For she was beguiled by an inferior and subject, he by an equal. Again, it is not said of the man, that he "saw the tree was good for food," but of the woman, and that she "did eat, and gave it to her husband": so that he transgressed, not captivated by appetite, but merely from the persuasion of his wife. The woman taught once, and ruined all. On this account therefore he says, let her not teach. But what is it to other women, that she suffered this? It certainly concerns them; for the sex is weak and fickle, and he is speaking of the sex collectively. For he says not Eve, but "the woman," which is the common name of the whole sex, not her proper name. Was then the whole sex included in the transgression for her fault? As he said of Adam, "After the similitude of Adam's transgression, who is the figure of Him that was to come" (Romans 5:14); so here the female sex transgressed, and not the male. Shall not women then be saved? Yes, by means of children. For it is not of Eve that he says, "If they continue in faith and charity and holiness with sobriety." What faith? What charity? What holiness with sobriety? It is as if he had said, "You women, be not cast down, because your sex has incurred blame. God has granted you another opportunity of salvation, by the bringing up of children, so that you are saved, not only by yourselves, but by others." See how many questions are involved in this matter. "The woman," he says, "being deceived was in the transgression." What woman? Eve. Shall she then be saved by child-bearing? He does not say that, but, the race of women shall be saved. Was not it then involved in transgression? Yes, it was, still Eve transgressed, but the whole sex shall be saved, notwithstanding, "by childbearing." And why not by their own personal virtue? For has she excluded others from

Continued on Page 9

"Great modesty and great propriety does the blessed Paul require of women, and that not only with respect to their dress and appearance: he proceeds even to regulate their speech."

September 2: St Stephen, King

Ruler of Hungary

Fr Alban Butler

From Butler's Lives of the Saints, *Benziger Brothers Edition.*

Geysa, fourth Duke of Hungary, was, with his wife, converted to the Faith, and saw in a vision the martyr St. Stephen, who told him that he should have a son who would perfect the work he had begun. This son was born in 977, and received the name of Stephen. He was most carefully educated, and succeeded his father at an early age. He began to root out idolatry, suppressed a rebellion of his pagan subjects, and founded monasteries and churches all over the land. He sent to Pope Sylvester, begging him to appoint bishops to the eleven sees he had endowed, and to bestow on him, for the greater success of his work, the title of king. The Pope granted his requests, and sent him a cross to be borne before him, saying that he regarded him as the true apostle of his people. His devotion was fervent. He placed his realms under the protection of our blessed Lady, and kept the feast of her Assumption with peculiar affection. He gave good laws, and saw to their execution. Throughout his life, we are told, he had Christ on his lips, Christ in his heart, and Christ in all he did. His only wars were wars of defense, and he was always successful. God sent him many and sore trials. One by one his children died, but he bore all with perfect submission to the will of God. When St. Stephen was about to die, he summoned the bishops and nobles, and gave them charge concerning the choice of a successor. Then he urged them to nurture and cherish the Catholic Church, which was still as a tender plant in Hungary, to follow justice, humility, and charity, to be obedient to the laws, and to show ever a reverent submission to the Holy See. Then, raising his eyes towards heaven, he said, "O Queen of Heaven, august restorer of a prostrate world, to thy care I commend the Holy Church, my people, and my realm, and my own departing soul." And then, on his favorite feast of the Assumption, in 1038, he died in peace.

Reflection—"Our duty," says Father Newman, "is to follow the Vicar of Christ whither he goeth, and never to desert him, however we may be tried; but to defend him at all hazards and against all corners, as a son would a father, and as a wife a husband, knowing that his cause is the cause of God."



St Stephen, *ora pro nobis!*

Sermon on Women Cont.

Continued from Page 8

this salvation? And what will be the case with virgins, with the barren, with widows who have lost their husbands, before they had children? Will they perish? Is there no hope for them? Yet virgins are held in the highest estimation. What then does he mean to say?

Some interpret his meaning thus. As what happened to the first woman occasioned the subjection of the whole sex, (for since Eve was formed second and made subject, he says, let the rest of the sex be in subjection,) so because she transgressed, the rest of the sex are also in transgression. But this is not fair reasoning; for at the creation all was the gift of God, but in this case, it is the consequence of the woman's sin. But this is the amount of what he says. As all men died through one, because that one sinned, so the whole female race transgressed, because the woman was in the transgression. Let her not however grieve. God has given her no small consolation, that of childbearing. And if it be said that this is of nature, so is that also of nature; for not only that which is of nature has been granted, but also the bringing up of children. "If they continue in faith and charity and holiness with sobriety"; that is, if after childbearing, they keep them in charity and purity. By these means they will have no small reward on their account, because they have trained up wrestlers for the service of Christ. By holiness he means good life, modesty, and sobriety.

Let us consider Chapter iii. ver. 1. "This is a faithful saying."

This relates to the present subject, not to what follows, respecting the office of a Bishop. For as it was doubted, he affirms it to be a true saying, that fathers may be benefited by the virtue of their children, and mothers also, when they have brought them up well. But what if she be herself addicted to wickedness and vice? Will she then be benefited by the bringing up of children? Is it not probable that she will bring them up to be like herself? It is not therefore of any woman, but of the virtuous woman, that it is said she shall receive a great recompense for this also.

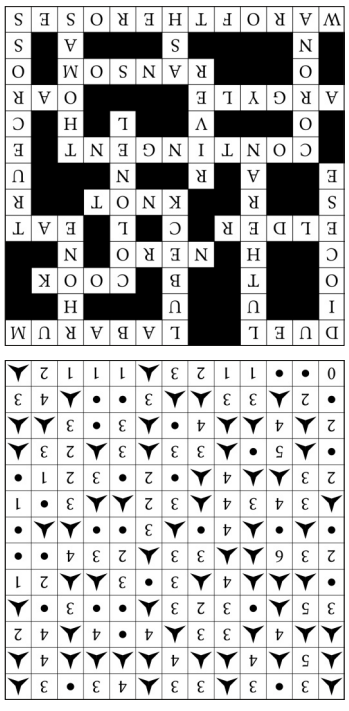
And what is the moral? Hear this, you fathers and mothers, that your bringing up of children shall not lose its reward. This also he says, as he proceeds, "Well reported of for good works; if she have brought up children." (1 Timothy 5:10) Among other commendations he reckons this one, for it is no light praise to devote to God those children which are given them of God. For if the basis, the foundation which they lay be good, great will be their reward; as great, if they neglect it, will be their punishment. It was on account of his children that Eli perished. For he ought to have admonished them, and indeed he did admonish them, but not as he ought; but from his unwillingness to give them pain he destroyed both himself and them. Hear this, you fathers, bring your children up with great care "in the nurture and admonition of the Lord." (Ephesians 6:4) Youth is wild, and requires many governors, teachers, directors, attendants, and tutors; and after all these, it is a happiness if it be restrained. For as a horse not broken in, or a wild beast untamed, such is youth. But if from the beginning, from the earliest age, we fix it in good rules, much pains will not be required afterwards; for good habits formed will be to them as a law. Let us not suffer them to do anything which is agreeable, but injurious; nor let us indulge them, as forsooth but children. Especially let us train them in chastity, for there is the very bane of youth. For this many struggles, much attention will be necessary. Let us take wives for them early, so that their brides may receive their bodies pure and unpolluted, so their loves will be more ardent. He that is chaste before marriage, much more will he be chaste after it; and he that practiced fornication before, will practice it after marriage. "All bread," it is said, "is sweet to the fornicator" (Sirach 23:17). Garlands are wont to be worn on the heads of bridegrooms, as a symbol of victory, betokening that they approach the marriage bed unconquered by pleasure. But if captivated by pleasure he has given himself up to harlots, why does he wear the garland, since he has been subdued?

Let us admonish them of these things. Let us employ sometimes advice, sometimes warnings, sometimes threatening. In children we have a great charge committed to us. Let us bestow great care upon them, and do everything that the Evil One may not rob us of them. But now our practice is the very reverse of this. We take all care indeed to have our farm in good order, and to commit it to a faithful manager, we look out for it an ass-driver, and muleteer, and bailiff, and a clever accomptant. But we do not look out for what is much more important, for a person to whom we may commit our son as the guardian of his morals, though this is a possession much more valuable than all others. It is for him indeed that we take such care of our estate. We take care of our possessions for our children, but of the children themselves we take no care at all. What an absurdity is this! Form the soul of your son aright, and all the rest will be added hereafter. If that is not good, he will derive no advantage from his wealth, and if it is formed to goodness he will suffer no harm from poverty. Would you leave him rich? Teach him to be good: for so he will be able to acquire wealth, or if not, he will not fare worse than they who possess it. But if he be wicked, though you leave him boundless wealth, you leave him no one to take care of it, and you render him worse than those who are reduced to extreme poverty. For poverty is better than riches for those children who are not well-disposed. For it retains them in some degree of virtue even against their will. Whereas money does not suffer those who would be sober to continue so, it leads them away, ruins them, and plunges them into infinite dangers.

Mothers, be specially careful to regulate your daughters well; for the management of them is easy. Be watchful over them, that they may be keepers at home. Above all, instruct them to be pious, modest, despisers of wealth, indifferent to ornament. In this way dispose of them in marriage. For if you form them in this way, you will save not only them, but the husband who is destined to marry them, and not the husband only, but the children, not the children only, but the grandchildren. For the root being made good, good branches will shoot forth, and still become better, and for all these you will receive a reward. Let us do all things therefore, as benefiting not only one soul, but many through that one. For they ought to go from their father's house to marriage, as combatants from the school of exercise, furnished with all necessary knowledge, and to be as leaven able to transform the whole lump to its own virtue. And let your sons be so modest, as to be distinguished for their steadiness and sobriety, that they may receive great praise both from God and men. Let them learn to govern their appetites, to avoid extravagance, to be good economists, affectionate, and submissive to rule. For so they will be able to secure a good reward to their parents, so all things will be done to the glory of God, and to our salvation, through Christ Jesus our Lord.

"Mothers, be specially careful to regulate your daughters well; for the management of them is easy. Be watchful over them, that they may be keepers at home."

PUZZLE SOLUTIONS



Tribute to Marshal Pétain

Defender of Catholic France

Quentin Douté

Marshal Pétain, French hero of the Great War and leader of Vichy France, knew well the devastation that liberalism had had on the France of his day. As leader he desired that the new France would be "a social hierarchy... rejecting the false idea of the natural equality of men", in line with the pre-1789 France before the revolution. Amongst French Catholics, he is admired as a defender of Christendom in France against the liberal-athiest and judeo-masonic forces of the Allies of WWII.

On the occasion of the 75th anniversary of the death of Marshal Pétain, the National-Catholic Movement wishes to pay tribute to the man who saved France twice: in 1916–1917, first by winning the Battle of Verdun against the German invader, and then by firmly yet humanely putting an end to the mutinies of 1917; in 1940, by signing an armistice necessary for France's survival, which was threatened following the senseless war waged by the politicians of the Judeo-Masonic Third Republic against National Socialist Germany out of pure ideology, a war that was poorly prepared and poorly directed against a German army stronger than ever.

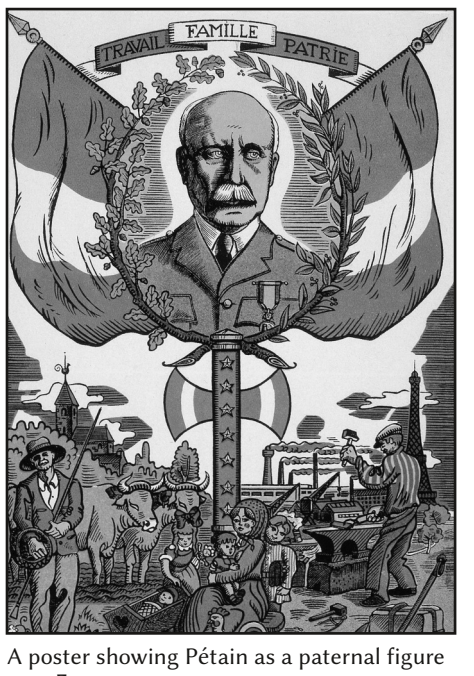
We particularly salute his salvific work of the National Revolution, undertaken after the armistice. As Archbishop Feltin of Bordeaux summarized it as early as September 1940: "The new social order that the Head of State wishes to establish in France is clearly inspired by papal teachings, as well as by national traditions and qualities." Cardinal Gerlier, Archbishop of Lyon, for his part said as early as the summer of 1940: "Work, Family, Fatherland: these three words are ours!"

Breaking with the hatred of God that was the sole consistent policy of the Third Republic, the Marshal demonstrated his respect for spiritual authority by submitting to the approval of Pope Pius XII the Principles of the Community that he wished to give to a renewed France, as well as the 1941 Statute of the Jews. Furthermore, on November 18, 1940, at the request of the Marquis de La Franquerie, the Pope's chamberlain, the Marshal consecrated France to the Immaculate Heart of Mary, an act officially renewed in March 1943 at the Church of Saint-Louis in Vichy.

Ignominiously imprisoned on the Île d'Yeu by a usurping government resulting from the Bolshevik insurrection of the summer of 1944 and from the dissent of former General de Gaulle, Marshal Pétain, who had given himself to France on June 17, 1940, agreed, at the request of his chaplain, to give France his sufferings as well: may his merits and his prayers save our Fatherland, which has such great need of them!

Frenchmen, let us pray for the Marshal; Monsieur le Maréchal, pray for France!

Quentin Douté, Secretary-General of the National-Catholic Movement



A poster showing Pétain as a paternal figure over France.

NOTE FROM THE EDITOR

Welcome dear Reader to the twelfth issue of *The Plough.*

It has been one year since the release of the first ever issue. I am indebted to all the readership for your support, and am likewise grateful to all those who have lent their support by an encouraging word, or by some other means.

My note for this month is taken from an interview conducted by Mr Stephen Kokx of *Integrity Magazine.* I hope you will find it good reading.

Thank you for your loyal patronage, dear Reader, and may God bless you,

Editor of *The Plough.*

What is The Plough, and what inspired you to start it?

The Plough is a print-first monthly Catholic journal in the shape of a newspaper. It focuses on the Social Kingship of Our Lord, family life, political and theological topics from authors both old and new. I started The Plough because I noticed a decline in the willingness to confront the errors afflicting Church, State, and family life. Catholics today are worn down by the unnatural and overwhelming forces of modern life—this being no mere accident—, and in this wearing-down, we risk compromising on matters of doctrine. This, in turn, blinds and frustrates our efforts to restore all things in Christ. I noticed a hesitancy of the Catholic milieu to engage in the social sphere, and even in the family sphere, where instead only a vague individual holiness is preached.

I started *The Plough* to be a demonstration of the incompatibility of Our Lord's teaching with the world, particularly the modern world, and to showcase what we as laymen can do about it.

Why did you do a print newspaper in this digital age?

Our Holy religion is one of the Incarnation. God, creator of everything, deigned to enter into our world below and live amongst us—physically! God willed that He should be known not just by the private intelligence of the individual, but by all of His creation. For example, compare the Catholic religion with modern protestantism: Catholics have cathedrals, protestants have halls. Catholics have the crucifix, protestants have a bare cross, if even that. Catholics have statues of the saints, and protestants have an invisible 'direct line' to God. In imitation of Our Lord, our religion should take up physical space!

The Plough as a newspaper indeed takes up space: it is kept on the dining table between meals, it is read on public transport, it can be shared with someone after Mass. I have even read it on a plane, which was the occasion for quite an interesting conversation with my co-traveller. A newspaper brings Catholic social doctrine out from the minds of the authors and into physical reality.

We aim to make *The Plough* beautiful too. The modern world is synonymous with ugly, and so making The Plough visually attractive is a small act of counter-revolution!

Has there been growth with subscribers? What do you think that says about Catholics today?

Readership is steadily growing. Catholics today are very busy. Books can be too much, while doom-scrolling is too easy. I wanted to fill a gap somewhere in between. For some, *The Plough* is enjoyed while eating breakfast quickly and diving headfirst into the day's rush-hour traffic. For others, it is enjoyed with the family at the end of the day by the fire. We have a free digital option too, which many readers go for, but it only imitates the full *Plough* experience. I know of several groups who print out the digital copies to distribute at their meetings. We are very encouraging of this. Donations are always welcome and go a long way towards *The Plough* being produced into the future.

How do you determine which essays are included in each edition?

The editorial line is simple: whatever is Catholic and can be reconciled with Catholic teaching before the revolutions of the 20th century, both in Church and civil society can be included. Each issue invariably contains a mixture of anti-liberal writings from authors old and new, a piece on the roles of womanhood or motherhood, military campaigns, great Catholic leaders, the Jewish question, consumerism and Catholic economics, and the building of brotherhood on the natural and supernatural foundations. Featured also is a small puzzle section. Readers too are welcome to make submissions, or write a letter to the editor.

Which writers (both clergy and laity) do you find the most beneficial to read in this particular time in Church history?

The list is long, but it would certainly include: Fr Denis Fahey, Fr Vincent McNabb, Pope Leo XIII, Arno Arcand (of the Daily Fight), Mr Theo Howard. All of these authors have featured in *The Plough.* They touch on the fundamental reasons why things are the way they are today, and in their totality, they provide the most compelling blue-print for setting awright our perilous situation.

Every author of history that has witnessed the truth has something to offer our times. Thought there are repeating patterns in history, each age contains something new. Historical authors, even the greatest, can't possibly address all concrete particulars of the problems of our age. So while the likes of Cardinal Pie and even Fr Fahey are indispensable today, I would argue that they are not sufficient. That is why *The Plough* publishes both old and new: to show men today what our forefathers of old thought, and to adapt this wisdom—amended with contemporary Catholic thought—to today's fight.

What do you think Catholics today are most in need of? Theology? Philosophy? History? Political Theory?

God has given different jobs for different men, so there isn't a single concrete answer to this question. Generally, Catholics today are in most need of the truth. For many, perhaps the majority, the truth—plainly told and often repeated—on basic matters of the moral life is what will serve them best: marriage and feminism, justice in our dealings with our neighbour, the correct use of authority and so on. For some, particularly intelligent young men, it is a different story. What's missing from these men's formation is the development of a magnanimity of soul that would direct them towards a leading role in restoring order to the nations. For these men, they will profit from Theology, Philosophy, History and Political Theory all rolled into one.

Another element that *The Plough* seeks to encourage is the practice of organising corporate action: co-operatives, music groups, homebrew, exercise, reading groups—anything! We mustn't allow intellectualism to stifle action, but rather, our intellectual formation should be the principle and compass of our action. From this organising, leaders emerge. And God, in His own time, will use this pool of leaders for His own ends as He sees fit.

What does success look like for The Plough?

Success for *The Plough* is confirming laymen in the traditional doctrine of The Church—the Pillar of Truth–and motivating them towards action, whether it be within one's own soul, in the family, or highest of all, in the civil society. In every generation God is raising up souls to perform a particular role in His plan. I think that God is raising up young men to re-establish a Christian world, one nation at a time, based on justice, order, and love. If The Plough can be coincident to that, then that will be *The Plough's* greatest success.

Anything else to add?

Thank you Mr. Kokx for your gracious interview, and Godspeed your work, and the work of all the writers, at Integrity Magazine.

Hail Christ.

THANK YOU, DEAR READER,
FOR YOUR SUPPORT.



The Cross Returned to the Schools of Nationalist Spain

Future of The Nation Assured

Fr C. Bayle SJ

From The Polish Militia Immaculata magazine, personally printed by Fr Kolbe, 1939. Our author, an English Jesuit was a member of the group, and penned this article praising Francisco Franco's Spain for his anti-liberal and pro-Catholic policies.

The Cross was removed from the schools of Spain by means of a brutal decree of the Republic. Its worthy representative, Azaña, believed that by the votes of Parliament he could erase the history of the nation, change its heart, reason, and soul shaped over centuries. "Spain has ceased to be Catholic," Azaña proclaimed, and from that moment godlessness was given legal sanction.

Atheism, that age-old persecutor of the Church and oppressor of conscience, ordered the Cross to be driven out of the schools.

The protest of the nation did not concern the authorities who at that time represented Spain.

Hundreds of thousands of signatures protesting against the ministerial orders were disregarded.

The authorities did not care that in some localities crowds of children placed the removed crosses beneath a canopy, while some shameless individuals mocked their profound veneration. The authorities did not hear how, in other centers, boys and girls, tears in their eyes, begged for the Cross to be left within the school walls; the authorities did not see how the crosses were solemnly, processionally transferred from the schools to the churches.

In one school, one of the teachers gave the removed Cross to the children. Each of them took it for one day and kept it as his or her own possession. In another locality, the mayor gave all the children a small cross, and they wore them on their breasts—One hundred crosses instead of one!

The introduction of the Cross into the schools was initiated by the liberation movement quickly and solemnly.

Nationalist Spain settled this matter quickly, in order to show that it wished to be Catholic. It was its first instinct. — The first and general one; so general that an order from the authorities was unnecessary, since the nation had preceded it. This was so at the beginning of the liberation movement. Later, by special orders in the various provinces as they were conquered, the Cross was installed in a place of honor.

The General of the 7th Division notified his subordinates in his district: "In all schools the Cross which was removed from them by the Reds must be restored" (August 22, 1936).

The Governor of Corunna (Cozuna), in his order, said: "Spanish — and Catholic — are two words which are identified both in the history and in the present reality of our nation. Therefore, it is necessary that the Cross, this symbol of our religion, should reign at the posts of our honor, never leave them, and be restored to the schools with the honors due to it."

Throughout Spain, ceremonies were begun to introduce the Cross into the schools, where it opened its arms before the eyes of innocent children, showing them at the dawn of life the path of truth, justice, and beauty.

The daily press was filled with descriptions of these truly national ceremonies, in which "the authorities and the people took part," and in which joy and tears mingled. Municipal councils, civil and military governors, representatives of the law, and scientific and literary corporations attended the blessing of crosses in the cathedrals of Cordoba, Cadiz, Badajoz, Burgos, and others…

The blessed crosses were carried by children, escorted by the military and police, to the schools.

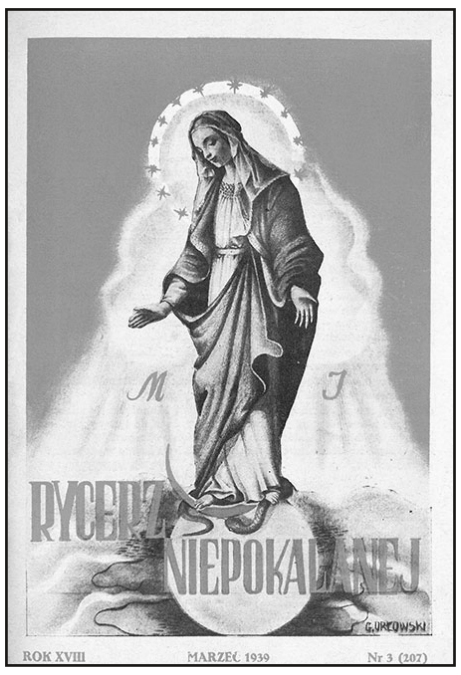
In Orense, the chief of the Civil Guard, at the head of the procession, presented the blessed Cross to the school, while in Seville General Queipo de Llano attended the blessing of the Cross by the cardinal and spoke the following words: "This act is for me the most important of all those I have attended during the liberation movement, and I think that the most important thing for a good patriot is religion, because he who does not love God does not love his family and therefore cannot be useful to his Fatherland."

Could the intensified manifestations and expressions of this Catholicism in schools be merely an empty and barren formula without a deeper element and without fruits?

No! This manifestation is born from the Spanish soul. In these Catholic schools and in the declarations of its leaders, the essence of the Spanish soul and its collective instinct are brought into relief.

Today the Catholic teachers' association, which did not perish during the days of the most terrible upheaval, is marked by strength and, armed with it, implants and strengthens in the souls of its pupils the love of God and Fatherland. To the plague of corrupt, atheistic youth, the association opposes youth that is sound and firmly grounded in Christianity.

On May 6, 1937, General Franco spoke at a teachers' congress in Salamanca: "Prayer and the sublime song for the Fatherland and the faith should be ended with one word: 'amen.' We are witnessing the rebirth of a nation with hot blood and a soul full of holy ideals. Its heroic deeds are of such a kind that they have overshadowed the men of history. The children of this nation are entrusted to you; see to it that they walk along the paths of truth and goodness; such is the command of God, such is the command of the blood that has been shed. Let this divine command be respected in Christian education; this is what Spain which fights and Spain which governs desires."



Original Cover of *Militia Immaculata*, 1939


Franco giving the Roman Salute.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

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The Land and Unemployment

We Have the Men and We Have The Land

Fr Vincent McNabb

Our author collaboratored with English Catholic greats Hilaire Belloc and G.K. Chesterton. Fr McNabb was a champion of the rural classes, and lamented greatly the denaturing effect that modern life has upon the souls of men.

As the next few years – or months? – may see no attempt to deal with the questions of unemployment and the land, it is imperative that Catholics, who alone have the ultimate principles of solution, shall also have the proximate principles of solution.

Unemployment—The Land

Our first discovery is the principle that these two questions are, perhaps, fundamentally one. In other words, "men are unemployed because the land is unemployed." There is even a striking parallelism between the two questions. Thus the evil of unemployment is made worse by the evil of under-employment. Not only are there some million and a half who are doing nothing, and, indeed, are paid for doing nothing, but there are some two millions doing little, and being paid for doing little. In most of the great industries the employees are not working full-time. All this is an incalculable loss to the real wealth of the country, even though men are not always conscious of this loss as they are conscious of other losses. After the short railway strike of 1919 there were experts who gave us a harrowing statement of the work hours that had been lost to the country. But who can calculate the work hours lost in the seven years since the war, during which time a million and a quarter men have been standing idle every day, and some three millions have been idle part of every day?

Men and Land Idle

As it is with the living worker, so it is with the land from which alone the worker has his living. As there are now a million and a half men standing idle, so there are millions of acres of English soil standing idle. Moreover, as there are millions of English workers underworking, so are there millions of English acres under-tilled. To the lover of England even a railway journey through this land has thoughts too deep for tears – or curses. This land is amongst the richest in the world. It is inhabited by people who are counted amongst the most intelligent in the world. Yet this national intelligence, which has organized the marvels of under-water sailing and air-flight and wireless telegraphy, has left the land as undeveloped as if the landdwellers were mentally deficient and not mentally efficient.

For the moment, therefore, let us note the parallelism between the two problems of the Unemployed and the Land, in the surmise that these two so kindred problems may prove to be one.

Agriculture v. Machinery

A further principle is that "machine and factory organization is not as efficient as agricultural organization for dealing with unemployment". But we add the necessary condition, that it must be a genuinely agricultural organization, and not that worst of all economic diseases, an industrialized agricultural organization, which produces not for home consumption, but for market-selling!

We admit, at the outset, that such an industrial organization of agriculture, with its long distances between production and consumption, is as economically unstable and vulnerable as a small army operating with a long line of communication between its fighting front and its base.

But a genuinely agricultural organization, where the areas of production and consumption are practically co-terminous, has no equal as an efficient economic unit for creating real wealth and preventing unemployment. The ultimate economic cause of this may be found in the ultimate unit of the organization. In a land organization, with its simple elements of soil and toil, the ultimate objective unit is the land. In a factory industrial organization, with its machinery, the ultimate unit is the machine. But, whereas the land is plastic in its power of absorbing toil, the machine is practically static.

A Machine's Limits

A machine as such cannot employ more than a certain number of hands. Moreover, the more efficient the machine, the fewer hands it will employ. This principle is now so undeniable that some of the economists even of the Labour Party are enunciating the principle that machinery should either not be made more efficient, or its output should be artificially restricted – lest labour starve!

But in contrast with this limited power of the machine to employ labour in creating wealth is the almost unlimited power of the land. For all those who do not at once see this far-reaching principle England is there as an object-lesson. Since 1870 as many workers have left the land as now stand idle round the Labour Exchanges. Yet even in 1870 England was a highly under-tilled land. There was a good deal of mass production, but there was practically no intensive production. Moreover, there was everywhere the financial incubus of the market and the price, which was gradually driving out the homestead and home consumption. In other words, the less efficient was ousting the more efficient economic organization.

A False Conclusion

It is not easy to see through the entanglements of modern business methods the natural simplicities of an agricultural organization. Even the tillers of the soil have gradually become so warped by town methods of marketing and money-making as not to see the wood for the trees. Thus government Ministers of Agriculture and secretaries of Farmers' or Labourers' Associations will be heard to deny that the land could more easily be organized to absorb all our unemployed than could any other industry. In making this denial they are arguing quite consistently. But they are arriving at a false conclusion by arguing from the falsehood in an ambiguous principle. If we ask them the fateful question: "Can you so organize your land as to absorb our unemployed?" they will reply: "No. We cannot." But this denial is based on the ambiguity of the word organize. It is apparent that this word may mean (a) the organization of the work; or (b) the organization of the wage. In other words, to organize may mean the real organization or the financial organization. These two are different and separable. Thus the Panama Canal was for a long time financially organized before it was really organizable. On the other hand, the real organization of national house-building is quite simple; but the financial organization of our national house-building baffles even our financial geniuses and our most disinterested statesman.

Back to the Land

Now the real organization of the land of England for the absorption of our unemployed is an elementary problem in agriculture. It is not to be compared to the difficulty solved by the military authorities during the war, when they suddenly absorbed some seven or eight million men. There is not a countryside, there is scarcely a Rural District Council in England which could not successfully undertake the real organization of twice as many as its quota needed to absorb all the unemployed. Moreover, this absorption would produce real primary wealth such as food, clothing, housing; and not mere secondary wealth such as highways, thoroughfares, and means of transport. When, therefore, farmers say that they could not organize the land so as to absorb the unemployed they do not mean "We cannot find work for the unemployed to do," but "We cannot find wages for their work." It is the financial, and not the real, organization they shirk.

> "It is not easy to see through the entanglements of modern business methods the natural simplicities of an agricultural organization. Even the tillers of the soil have gradually become so warped by town methods of marketing and money-making as not to see the wood for the trees."

So simple and subtle is Nature that no man-made device can be her equal in meeting fluctuations of workers and work. No machine will depreciate so little if left standing idle. No machine can deal so successfully with a sudden influx of workers. The machine has only a limited capacity both in accommodation and function. It cannot employ more than a small group, unless the shifts are shortened. It cannot undertake any other than the specialized operation for which it was designed. But a tract of land in England can exist with a handful of workers; or can keep a worker or two for every acre. Moreover, it can produce every kind of real wealth from the stone that built Salisbury Minster to the wool that makes the world's best homespuns and the wheat and grapes that may become the Sacrifice of a World Redeemed.

The Catholics of England

Our forefathers met one of the fiercest and most effective persecutions in history by flying to the land. When the persecution ceased and Catholics, like commerce, shifted their centre from the land to the towns, Catholics did not grow in proportion to the growth of population. Immigration from Catholic Ireland seemed to hide the dwindling of their numbers. Neither the urban life nor the industrial atmosphere fitted in with their spiritual mentality. At length they, like the nation at large, have come upon such extremities of want that they are of the same mind as the Prodigal Son. Herding and feeding with swine reminds them of their Father's home in the country with its white bread and its fatted calf. So much is the freedom of their faith and the purity of their morals now engaged in this return to their Father's land of Bethlehem and Nazareth that no land proposals of the Government should find them asleep. They must be awake and alert lest the enemy oversow cockle in the wheat-sown field; or rob them both of their wheat and their field.

